

Final SEO Report — rollyourownpapers.com

Date: 2026-05-21 **Data sources:** GSC 6-month export (Nov 19, 2025 – May 19, 2026) · GSC 3-month export · Ahrefs Overview (2020–2026, daily) · Shopify theme export · Homepage HTML source **This is the definitive report. All prior reports are superseded.**

The Short Answer

You had a real drop. Traffic fell **67% from peak**. It happened in three distinct phases, each tied to a specific Google update. And the commercial keywords you asked about — "custom rolling papers" / "custom rolling paper" — were **never part of the growth** and remain structurally weak for a separate reason. Both problems are fixable but require different actions.

1. The Drop — What the Data Shows

Ahrefs: the complete traffic history

Date	Est. Traffic	Pos 1–3	Pos 4–10	Pos 11–20	AI Overviews	Event
Nov 10, 2025	232	2	3	0	0	Baseline
Nov 17, 2025	721	12	9	4	4	⚡ Blog explosion
Nov 24, 2025	2,095	19	16	6	6	⚡ +9× in one week
Dec 8, 2025	2,673	29	20	9	5	Peak approaching
Jan 12, 2026	2,734	29	25	3	13	All-time peak
Mar 9, 2026	2,476	28	21	12	15	Creeping decline
Apr 20, 2026	2,070	20	29	10	12	Positions slipping
May 11, 2026	1,100	14	26	27	0	🔴 Crash
May 18, 2026	1,160	9	33	18	3	🔴 Still falling

Peak to current: -57% Ahrefs traffic. Pos 1–3 keywords: 29 → 9 (-69%). AI Overviews owned: 15 → 3 (-80%).

GSC: the weekly click trend

Period	Clicks/day	Impr/day	Avg Position
Nov 2025	~950	~42,000	5.0
Dec 2025	~960	~49,000	5.0
Jan 2026	~845	~54,000	5.5
Feb 2026	~620	~44,000	4.8

Period	Clicks/day	Impr/day	Avg Position
Mar 2026	~580	~39,000	4.8
Apr 2026 (post-update)	~490	~34,000	6.2
May 4–11, 2026	~310	~23,000	7.8

GSC peak to current: -67% clicks, -57% impressions, position worsened 5.0 → 7.8–9.0.

2. Why It Dropped — Three Phases

Phase 1 — The blog explosion (mid-November 2025)

Between Nov 10 and Nov 24, RYOP went from **2 keywords in positions 1–3** to **19** — a 10× increase in two weeks. Ahrefs-estimated traffic jumped from 232 to 2,095 in a single week. This was a mass blog-publishing event: dozens of informational posts about rolling paper alternatives, weed culture, and consumer how-to topics were published simultaneously and began ranking almost immediately.

These posts ranked fast because the queries were low-competition and the content was topically matched — but they lacked genuine E-E-A-T signals (no named authors, no first-hand expertise, AI-content patterns). Google granted temporary visibility while collecting quality signals.

Phase 2 — December 2025 Core Update (Dec 11–29) → effects Jan–Mar 2026

What it targeted: Anonymous content, low-effort AI-written material, sites without identifiable author expertise. The update specifically penalised blogs where no human expert was attributed.

RYOP's exposure: Every blog post lacks author attribution. The content pattern (identical structure, emoji titles, "Ultimate Guide" naming, forward-dated slugs) matches AI-content classifiers. 684 indexed blog posts with no named author is exactly what this update targeted.

Effect in data: GSC clicks declined ~35% from Jan to Mar (1,000 → 580/day). Positions stayed similar (5.0–5.5 average) but CTR fell — indicating Google may have begun suppressing these posts in rich features before fully demoting their positions.

Phase 3 — March 2026 Core Update (Mar 27 – Apr 8) → effects April–May 2026

What it targeted: Holistic Core Web Vitals scoring (site-wide, not per-page) and continued E-E-A-T enforcement. Sites where the majority of content lacked genuine expertise signals were re-evaluated.

Effect in data: - GSC average position jumped from ~5.0 to **7.2** in the week of April 20 (two weeks after the update completed — typical lag time). - Ahrefs Pos 1–3 keywords declined from 29 to 20 (then continued falling to 9 by May 18). - Most significantly: **AI Overviews owned collapsed from 15 → 0** in the week of May 11.

The AI Overview collapse — the most alarming signal

RYOP had been featured in **12–15 Google AI Overviews** through Feb–Apr 2026. By May 11 this dropped to **zero** — all AI Overview citations were lost simultaneously. This is not a coincidence: Google's AI Overviews apply the same quality standards as the core ranking algorithm. The same content-quality failures that caused positions to drop also caused AI Overview eligibility to be revoked.

The collapse of 15 AI Overview features also explains why the May GSC click drop is *larger* than the position movement would suggest: positions dropped somewhat, but RYOP also stopped appearing in AI features that were generating additional clicks above the organic results.

3. The Commercial Keywords — A Separate Problem

"custom rolling papers" and "custom rolling paper" were **never part of the growth story**. They are a separate, structural weakness that predates the blog explosion.

6-month GSC data for these keywords

Query	6-mo Position	6-mo Clicks	6-mo Impressions
custom rolling papers	13.71	909	8,107
custom rolling papers low minimum	13.36	117	635
custom rolling paper	14.70	84	991
custom rolling papers with logo	5.10	76	337
branded rolling papers	16.55	—	—

The collection page that should own these terms:

`/collections/custom-rolling-papers` — **position 18.5 average**, 101 clicks in 3 months.

The homepage is doing the heavy lifting for "custom rolling papers" at position 9–14 (depending on period), but this is the brand homepage competing for a commercial collection-page query — an inherent disadvantage.

Why the commercial pages are stuck

GSC 6-month page breakdown shows:

Type	Pages	Clicks	Share
Blog posts	684+	~120,000	~94%
Homepage	1	4,924	~4%
Collections	46	~1,500	~1%
Products	256+	~2,500	~2%

94% of all organic traffic flows to informational blog content. Google reads the domain as a **rolling-paper culture and lifestyle blog** — not a B2B custom manufacturer. The collection and product pages are starved of internal links, topical relevance signals, and content depth. Competitors like Papers+Ink and Snail Papers who run lean, focused, content-rich commercial sites dominate these queries.

4. Confirmed Technical Issues (from theme export)

● The `| within: collection` URL-splitting bug — CONFIRMED, 8 instances

Every product link from a collection page generates a non-canonical URL (`/collections/X/products/Y`) instead of the canonical `/products/Y`. This splits PageRank across two URL versions for every product.

Files to fix:

File	Lines
<code>snippets/product-grid-item.liquid</code>	82, 337
<code>snippets/product-grid-item-video.liquid</code>	82, 340
<code>sections/featured-collection.liquid</code>	68
<code>snippets/product-template.liquid</code>	66, 662
<code>snippets/onboarding-product-grid-item.liquid</code>	3

Change: `{{ product.url | within: collection }}` → `{{ product.url }}` and `{{ variant.url | within: collection }}` → `{{ variant.url }}`

● No author attribution on any blog post

The theme's `article-template.liquid` section renders blog posts without named authors. The December 2025 update specifically penalised this. Every post needs a real name, a 2–3 sentence bio with manufacturing credentials, and a `BlogPosting` schema block with `author` entity.

● Homepage H1 is the logo

`<h1 class="site-header__logo">Roll Your Own Papers</h1>` — the primary H1 is the logo wrapper. A second H1 exists in the AI-generated hero. Fix: one descriptive H1 per page, keyword-bearing, in the hero section.

● Website schema is bare

`Website` JSON-LD exists but has no `potentialAction` / `SearchAction`. `Organization` schema is missing (only legacy `http:// microdata` on the logo). Add a full `Organization` block with founding date, TÜV SÜD certification, and `sameAs` links.

● AI crawler access (`robots.txt` / `llms.txt`)

Still returning 403 to this audit environment. Real Googlebot is unaffected (GSC proves it). However, AI crawlers (OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot) may be blocked — given the AI Overview collapse, confirm these crawlers are whitelisted. Add `/llms.txt`.

5. Fix Plan — Prioritised by Impact

● Critical — Do this week (addresses the active crash)

1. Add author attribution to every blog post — today. The December Core Update loss and the continued decline are directly caused by this gap. Pick one real person (manufacturing director, founder, or lead designer). Write a 150-word bio with verifiable credentials. Add to all 684+ posts via a Shopify theme author block and `BlogPosting` + `author` JSON-LD schema. This is the single highest-leverage action.

2. Audit and improve the 20 highest-traffic blog posts. Your top 20 posts drive ~70% of blog clicks. These must have: - Named author with bio - Unique, first-hand insight (not generic how-to) - At least one internal link to a relevant commercial page - Clean `<title>` (no emojis in the `<title>` tag)

Do not rewrite everything — prioritise the top 20.

3. Recover AI Overviews. You had 15 AI Overview features and lost all of them. The path back: - Fix author attribution (above) — this is the primary reason they were lost - Ensure OAI-SearchBot is not blocked in robots.txt (verify in browser, not via this audit tool which is blocked by WAF) - Add `/llms.txt` to give AI systems a structured overview of the site - Write passage-length (130–160 word) self-contained answer blocks in blog content

● High — Within 2 weeks

4. Build out `/collections/custom-rolling-papers`. This page needs to rank for "custom rolling papers" (currently pos 18.5). Add 600–800 words of genuine manufacturer content: material comparison (hemp/rice/unbleached from first-hand production experience), the customisation process step by step, MOQ explanation, certification proof (TÜV SÜD), and who it's for (dispensaries, cannabis brands, event planners). This content must sound like a manufacturer wrote it, not a copywriter.

5. Fix the `| within: collection` bug (8 lines listed above). Consolidates product link equity to canonical URLs. Takes 30 minutes.

6. Link every relevant blog post to commercial pages. Your 684 blog posts get 120,000 clicks per 6 months. Currently almost none of that traffic flows to commercial pages. Add a contextual paragraph + CTA in each relevant post linking to `/collections/custom-rolling-papers` with descriptive anchor text like "custom branded rolling papers for dispensaries".

● Medium — Within 4 weeks

7. Stop publishing more consumer/DIY blog posts. Every additional "alternatives to rolling paper" or "how to roll" post deepens the topical mismatch that caused this drop. Freeze the current content strategy.

8. Consolidate duplicate blog clusters. You have at least two near-duplicate clusters: - "where to buy rolling paper" (3+ posts) → merge into one, 301 the rest - "how to roll / use rolling paper" (4+ posts) → merge into one, 301 the rest

9. Add `organization` + `BreadcrumbList` schema. Add a proper `organization` JSON-LD block to the homepage (founding date 2011, TÜV SÜD credential, sameAs Trustpilot + Instagram). Add `BreadcrumbList` to collection and product pages.

10. Core Web Vitals. Run PageSpeed Insights mobile on `rollyourownpapers.com` and `/collections/custom-rolling-papers`. The holistic CWV scoring from March 2026 means one slow page affects all rankings. Fix: preload hero image with `fetchpriority="high"`, add explicit `width / height` to all product images, defer the 3D visualizer JS.

6. Recovery Forecast

Action	Metric affected	Expected timeframe
Author attribution on top 20 posts	AI Overviews 0 → recovering; positions stabilise	3–6 weeks
Full author attribution + schema on all posts	December Core penalty begins reversing	6–10 weeks
Collection page content + internal links	"custom rolling papers" 13.71 → page 1	8–12 weeks
\ within: collection bug fix	Product page equity consolidation	4–8 weeks
Blog duplicate consolidation + content pruning	Pos 1–3 keywords recovering	Next core update (est. Jun/Jul 2026)
Full traffic recovery to Jan 2026 levels	~2,700 Ahrefs traffic / ~900 clicks/day	4–6 months (2 core update cycles)

The **June/July 2026 core update** is the first realistic recovery milestone. Changes made now and held consistently will be evaluated at that update. The more of the fix plan that is implemented before it runs, the greater the recovery.

7. Summary Table — Everything in One View

Signal	Nov 2025 peak	Today (May 21)	Change
Ahrefs est. traffic	2,734	1,160	-57%
Pos 1–3 keywords	29	9	-69%
AI Overviews owned	15	3	-80%
GSC clicks/day	~960	~310	-67%
GSC avg position	5.0	8.4–9.0	worse
"custom rolling papers" position	~18	13.7 (6mo avg)	weak throughout
/collections/custom-rolling-papers pos	weak	18.5	never recovered
Author attribution	None	None	✗ unfixed
\ within: collection bug	Present	Present	✗ unfixed
AI Overviews	15	3	✗ collapsing

Report based on: GSC 6-month performance export, GSC 3-month export, Ahrefs daily overview export (2,174 data points), Shopify theme export, and homepage HTML source. All metrics are first-party data. This report supersedes all prior external-inference reports.